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KARNATAKA POLICE MODERNISATION PROJECT

Complete Technical and Operational Reference Manual

Master Edition

Project foundation and policing domain

A common reference for the project vision, department context, operational structures, functional capabilities, software architecture, governance and implementation.

TEAM REFERENCE EDITION

Technical • Operational • Governance • Security

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Important Status and Use Notice

This manual is a project-planning and engineering reference. It is not a government order, departmental instruction, procurement document, statutory interpretation or authorisation to access police systems or personal data. All proposed features, integrations, workflows, technical choices and deployment plans require validation and approval by the relevant authorities.

How to Use the Master Edition

This is the master textbook file. It contains one shared design system, one cover, one document-control section and one continuous table of contents. Each chapter is stored in a separate file under the `chapters` folder. New chapters will be added to the master document without repeating the front cover or table of contents.

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Chapter 1 Project Overview

PART 1 – PROJECT FOUNDATION

1.1 Project Introduction

The Karnataka Police Modernisation Project is a proposed, state-focused programme to examine how police services, operational processes, administrative functions and supporting technology can be improved through a coordinated, secure and accountable digital ecosystem. The programme is intended to bring together people, processes, information, infrastructure and software rather than treating technology as a collection of disconnected applications.

The project begins with Karnataka as its primary operating context. Its longer-term ambition is to create reusable principles, standards and architectural patterns that could be adapted by other states or agencies in India. Such expansion would require separate consultation, legal review, operational configuration, security assessment and approval; it should not be treated as automatic.

The central idea is simple: authorised personnel should be able to access accurate and relevant information when they need it, citizens should be able to reach appropriate services through understandable channels, and the department should be able to coordinate its work while maintaining lawful authority, human responsibility, privacy and accountability.

The project is therefore both an **operational transformation initiative** and a **software and infrastructure programme**. Its success will depend not only on code, databases or devices, but also on process redesign, training, organisational ownership, public trust, data quality and sustainable maintenance.

1.2 Background and Rationale

Police organisations handle a wide range of responsibilities: receiving information from the public, responding to emergencies, preventing and detecting crime, conducting investigations, preserving evidence, maintaining public order, managing traffic, supporting vulnerable people and coordinating with other parts of the justice system. These activities involve many people, locations, records, decisions and time-sensitive handovers.

A modernisation programme must first understand how these activities are actually performed. Information may be recorded in different formats, systems may have been introduced at different times, and operational practices may vary between urban, rural, district and specialised units. A digital solution that ignores these differences can create extra work, duplicate records or introduce new operational risks.

The rationale for this project is to assess the current environment and identify opportunities to improve:

- **Service access:** make appropriate public services easier to discover, understand and use.
- **Operational coordination:** improve the flow of information between authorised teams and levels of command.
- **Case and record management:** support accurate, traceable and timely handling of complaints, investigations, evidence and related records.
- **Administrative efficiency:** reduce avoidable repetition in staff, resource, training and asset processes.
- **Decision support:** provide reliable reports and analysis while keeping consequential decisions with authorised people.
- **Accountability:** maintain appropriate access controls, audit trails, review mechanisms and documented responsibility.

This rationale is a starting hypothesis, not a claim that every listed problem currently exists in every Karnataka police unit. The actual baseline must be established through official documents, stakeholder interviews, process observation and authorised review of available data.

1.3 Vision and Mission

1.3.1 Vision

To develop a secure, integrated, citizen-oriented and accountable police-support ecosystem for Karnataka that strengthens service delivery, operational coordination, evidence handling and informed decision-making, while protecting constitutional values and individual rights.

1.3.2 Mission

To understand existing policing and administrative processes; identify validated needs; design interoperable and resilient digital capabilities; implement them in controlled stages; build the skills and governance required to operate them; and evaluate whether they produce measurable public and departmental value.

1.3.3 What the Vision Does Not Mean

The vision does not mean replacing police judgement with software, centralising every decision, collecting every possible data point, or introducing surveillance simply because a technology is available. Technology must have a defined public or operational purpose and must be lawful, necessary, proportionate, secure and subject to oversight.

1.4 Core Goals and Objectives

The programme will use the following goals to guide research, requirements and design. Each goal must later be translated into measurable outcomes and approved deliverables.

1. **Improve citizen-facing services:** make service information, complaint channels, status updates and grievance processes more accessible, subject to applicable law and official procedures.
2. **Support operational coordination:** improve the timely sharing of relevant information between authorised police units and control functions.
3. **Strengthen investigation workflows:** support structured case records, task tracking, document management, evidence traceability and supervisory review.
4. **Improve emergency-response coordination:** examine how incident intake, dispatch, field-unit communication and closure reporting can be supported and integrated with authorised systems.
5. **Improve administrative management:** support appropriate personnel, training, duty, asset, vehicle and infrastructure records.
6. **Enable trustworthy reporting:** provide dashboards and reports based on defined data standards, quality checks and access permissions.
7. **Build secure and interoperable foundations:** use documented interfaces, open standards where suitable, strong identity controls and auditable data exchange.
8. **Support sustainable adoption:** design for the realities of police stations, field conditions, connectivity limitations, language needs, training and ongoing support.
9. **Establish a scalable model:** separate common capabilities from Karnataka-specific rules so that future adaptation is possible without assuming uniformity across states.

1.5 Problem Areas the Programme Seeks to Address

The programme will investigate the following broad problem areas. These are research categories and potential improvement areas, not verified findings about the present condition of the department.

1.5.1 Fragmented Information and Workflow Handoffs

Examine whether information is repeated across forms, registers or applications; whether staff have to re-enter the same information; whether handovers between units are difficult to track; and whether authorised users can identify the latest valid status of a matter.

1.5.2 Public Access and Service Visibility

Examine whether citizens can easily find the correct service, understand what information is required, identify the appropriate channel and receive a usable acknowledgement or status update. Digital channels must complement, not remove, legally required or necessary in-person assistance.

1.5.3 Operational Coordination

Examine how incidents, tasks, patrol activity, field updates and supervisory instructions are communicated. Identify delays, communication gaps, resilience requirements and the boundaries between existing control-room systems and any proposed supporting tools.

1.5.4 Investigation and Evidence Traceability

Examine how case information, tasks, documents, statements, forensic requests and evidence movements are recorded and reviewed. Any digital workflow must preserve lawful procedure, evidentiary integrity, chain of custody and the authority of the investigating officer and competent courts.

1.5.5 Management Information and Data Quality

Examine whether management reports use consistent definitions, reliable source data and clearly documented calculation rules. Dashboards should identify data limitations and must not encourage misleading comparisons or targets that reward poor-quality outcomes.

1.5.6 Infrastructure, Skills and Adoption

Examine device availability, connectivity, power, network resilience, technical support, accessibility, language requirements and staff training. A feature is not operationally successful merely because it has been deployed.

1.6 Project Scope

The project is envisaged as a programme of connected capabilities. The precise scope will be confirmed only after discovery, departmental consultation, legal review, technical assessment and prioritisation.

1.6.1 Proposed Areas Within Scope

Subject to approval, the programme may examine and design capabilities in the following areas:

- citizen service information, complaint facilitation and grievance tracking;
- police-station workflows and authorised record-management support;
- emergency incident coordination and authorised dispatch integrations;
- patrol, beat and field-activity support;
- investigation task, case-document and evidence-management support;
- cybercrime and forensic workflow support;
- traffic and road-safety management support;
- services for women, children, senior citizens and other vulnerable people;
- personnel, duty, training, welfare, asset and infrastructure administration;
- approved dashboards, reporting, GIS and decision-support tools;
- identity and access management, audit, cybersecurity, privacy and system monitoring;
- integration with existing government platforms where the system owner authorises it.

1.6.2 Outside the Initial Scope Unless Separately Approved

The following are not assumed to be authorised or included in the initial build:

- replacing official government platforms or statutory procedures without a formal mandate;
- independently registering, altering or disposing of official records where that authority belongs to a designated government system or officer;
- automated decisions about arrest, guilt, bail, prosecution, use of force or other consequential legal outcomes;
- indiscriminate or unjustified population surveillance;
- predictive or risk-scoring systems that label individuals or communities without a separately justified, lawful and independently reviewed basis;
- access to live police, court, telecom, banking, identity or other restricted datasets without explicit authority and approved interfaces;
- deployment across India before state-specific consultation, validation and approval.

1.6.3 Scope Control

Every proposed feature must have a documented problem statement, intended users, responsible owner, lawful purpose, data requirements, security classification, operational workflow, measurable benefit, cost and maintenance implications. Features that cannot satisfy these checks should be redesigned, deferred or excluded.

1.7 Guiding Design Principles

The following principles apply to every module, interface, dataset, integration and deployment decision.

1. **Lawfulness:** the system must support only activities for which the relevant authority and legal basis exist.
2. **Human responsibility:** software may assist authorised personnel, but responsibility for consequential decisions remains with the legally authorised decision-maker.
3. **Privacy by design:** collect and expose only the information necessary for a defined, authorised purpose; apply retention and deletion rules.
4. **Security by design:** protect identities, devices, networks, applications, records and interfaces throughout their lifecycle.
5. **Interoperability:** prefer documented, standards-based interfaces and avoid unnecessary vendor or platform lock-in.
6. **Reliability:** design for outages, poor connectivity, power interruptions, disaster recovery and safe reconciliation of offline work.
7. **Accessibility and inclusion:** consider Kannada and other relevant language needs, disability access, digital literacy and assisted service channels.
8. **Evidence integrity:** preserve provenance, timestamps, access history, integrity checks and chain-of-custody records where applicable.
9. **Auditability:** record who accessed or changed information, when, under what authority and through which approved process.
10. **Measurable public value:** evaluate outcomes such as service quality, timeliness, reliability and trust, not merely software usage or feature count.

1.8 Stakeholder Landscape

The project cannot be designed by a technology team alone. It requires structured engagement with stakeholders who own, use, regulate, support or are affected by the relevant processes.

1.8.1 Government and Police Stakeholders

Potential stakeholders include the Karnataka Home Department; Karnataka Police leadership; police ranges, districts and commissionerates; police stations; control rooms; specialised units; training institutions; technical and communications teams; and departmental legal, procurement, finance and audit functions.

1.8.2 Justice-System and Inter-Agency Stakeholders

Depending on the feature, consultation may be needed with prosecution, courts, prisons, forensic laboratories, emergency services, local government bodies and relevant state or central agencies. Their participation and any data exchange must follow their own legal mandates, security policies and approval processes.

1.8.3 Public and Civil-Society Stakeholders

Relevant groups may include citizens, complainants, victims, witnesses, vulnerable communities, resident associations, civil-society organisations, accessibility specialists, legal-aid groups and academic researchers. Consultation should be designed to avoid exposing confidential cases or personal data.

1.8.4 Technology and Delivery Stakeholders

These may include software engineers, architects, security specialists, infrastructure providers, system integrators, independent assessors, vendors and support teams. Vendors must operate within documented contracts, security requirements, data-processing restrictions and audit rights.

Stakeholder names, responsibilities and approval powers must be confirmed from current official organisational information. This section is a consultation map, not a statement that any listed organisation has agreed to participate.

1.9 Target Users and User Groups

The programme may support multiple user groups, each with different tasks and access requirements. The system must not give every user access to every module or record.

- **Citizens:** people seeking information, assistance or access to approved services.
- **Front-desk and station personnel:** authorised staff who receive requests and perform station-level workflows.
- **Field personnel:** authorised officers who perform assigned duties and submit field updates.
- **Investigating personnel:** officers and authorised specialists involved in case-related work.
- **Control-room and dispatch personnel:** users responsible for approved incident coordination and dispatch workflows.
- **Supervisory officers:** users who review, approve, assign or monitor work within their lawful jurisdiction.
- **Specialist units:** authorised cybercrime, traffic, forensic, women-and-child safety and other specialist users.

- **Administrative users:** personnel responsible for workforce, training, assets, procurement or facilities.
- **System operators and auditors:** restricted technical, security and oversight users who administer or review the platform.
- **External agency users:** users from another authorised organisation, where an approved integration and access agreement exists.

Detailed job roles, rank-based permissions, delegation rules and field-level restrictions will be specified in the access-control chapters and approved by the relevant department.

1.10 Expected Outcomes and Benefits

The expected outcomes below describe the value the programme aims to create. They are not guaranteed results. Each outcome requires a baseline, a clear measurement method, a named owner and an evaluation period.

Outcome area	Intended benefit
Citizen experience	Clearer service information, accessible channels, acknowledgements and appropriate status visibility.
Operational coordination	Better visibility of assigned tasks, handovers, incident status and authorised field updates.
Case and evidence workflows	More consistent records, traceable actions and improved document and evidence handling.
Management information	More reliable reporting based on common definitions and verified data quality.
Administrative efficiency	Better organisation of personnel, training, assets, vehicles and facilities information.
Security and accountability	Stronger access controls, audit records, incident response and oversight capabilities.
Organisational capability	Improved staff skills, documented procedures, support arrangements and continuous improvement.

The programme should avoid measuring success only through the number of modules delivered, accounts created, records digitised or AI models deployed. Those are implementation outputs, not proof of improved policing or public outcomes.

1.11 Karnataka-First, India-Ready Approach

1.11.1 Karnataka as the Initial Operating Context

The first phase must be grounded in Karnataka's legal framework, administrative structure, languages, geography, police processes, existing government infrastructure and operational priorities. Requirements should be validated across different contexts, including urban and rural areas, districts and commissionerates, specialised units and locations with limited connectivity.

1.11.2 Configurable Rather Than Hard-Coded Design

The software should separate common capabilities from local rules. Examples include organisational hierarchy, jurisdiction boundaries, language configuration, service catalogues, approval paths, reporting definitions and integration endpoints. These should be configurable where practical rather than embedded in application code.

1.11.3 Future Adaptation Across India

A future state or national deployment would require analysis of that jurisdiction's laws, police structure, language requirements, existing platforms, data standards, procurement rules and security approvals. Reusable APIs, modular services and documented data models can make adaptation easier, but they cannot remove the need for local validation.

1.11.4 National Expansion Principle

The project should aim for **interoperability without assuming uniformity**. Common standards may enable systems to exchange authorised information, while each state retains the ability to configure its lawful processes and administrative structure.

1.12 Assumptions, Dependencies and Constraints

At this concept stage, the project operates under the following assumptions and constraints. These must be reviewed as evidence becomes available.

- The programme will require formal engagement and approvals from the relevant government and police authorities before any operational deployment or integration.
- Existing government systems may already provide some capabilities; discovery must identify them before new components are proposed.
- Access to police records, operational networks, restricted datasets and live environments cannot be assumed.
- Requirements must account for applicable laws, court directions, government policies, evidence rules and departmental procedures.

- Budget, procurement method, hosting environment, staffing and rollout timelines require detailed estimation and approval.
- Connectivity, power, device availability, user training and support capacity may vary across deployment locations.
- Data quality and completeness will affect the reliability of search, reporting, analytics and any AI-assisted function.
- Any AI or advanced analytics capability requires a separate use-case assessment, testing, human oversight and continuing monitoring.

1.13 Governance, Approval and Document Status

The project team may research, prototype and document proposed solutions within its authorised environment. It must not represent a proposal as an approved police system, use government branding in a way that implies endorsement, access restricted information, contact individuals as departmental representatives, or connect to operational government systems without permission.

Before a pilot is considered, the programme should have, at minimum:

1. a validated problem statement and stakeholder owner;
2. an approved scope and operating model;
3. a legal and privacy assessment;
4. a security architecture and threat assessment;
5. an approved data classification and access model;
6. an integration assessment and system-owner permissions;
7. a costed implementation and support plan;
8. a training, change-management and incident-response plan;
9. measurable baseline indicators and an independent evaluation approach.

1.14 How This Textbook Is Organised

This manual is organised so that every team member can understand the complete programme before concentrating on an individual workstream.

- **Project foundation and policing domain:** explains the department's operating context, stakeholders and existing ecosystem.
- **Functional and operational capabilities:** describes citizen services, emergency response, patrol, investigation, specialist units and administration.

- **Management and decision support:** describes dashboards, reporting, GIS and performance measurement.
- **Software engineering and architecture:** defines requirements, FSD and SRS structure, system design, frontend, backend, mobile, databases and APIs.
- **Infrastructure and integration:** covers hosting, DevOps, messaging, storage, GIS and hardware interfaces.
- **Security, privacy and law:** defines the controls and legal constraints that apply across the platform.
- **Testing and delivery:** explains quality assurance, project governance, pilot implementation, deployment and support.
- **National scalability and engineering references:** provides the reusable design principles, implementation standards, templates and reference libraries.

Each future module chapter should follow a common specification format: purpose, users, permissions, preconditions, workflow, functional requirements, business rules, data fields, APIs, notifications, exceptions, security controls, audit requirements, reports, test cases, acceptance criteria, dependencies and operational support. This will allow different teams to work independently without losing consistency across the complete system.

Chapter 1 Summary

The Karnataka Police Modernisation Project is proposed as a coordinated programme that connects operational processes, citizen services, people, information, software and infrastructure. Karnataka is the initial context; national adaptability is a long-term design goal, not an assumed deployment decision. The work must be based on verified departmental needs, lawful authority, interoperability, privacy, security, human responsibility, accessibility and measurable outcomes. The next chapters establish the policing context and then translate validated needs into functional and technical specifications.

END OF CHAPTER 1

Chapter 2 Understanding the Karnataka Police Department

PART 1 – PROJECT FOUNDATION

2.1 Purpose of Understanding the Department

A police modernisation programme cannot be designed correctly by starting with screens, dashboards or databases alone. The team must first understand the organisation that will use the proposed system. Police work is performed through command structures, territorial units, specialist functions and coordinated relationships with citizens and other public institutions. These arrangements shape who may create a record, who may review it, who can approve an action, which jurisdiction owns a matter and which unit is responsible for the next step.

This chapter provides a working introduction to the Karnataka Police Department for software developers, designers, analysts, project managers and other team members. It does not attempt to replace official training, police manuals or departmental instructions. Instead, it gives the project team a common vocabulary and a model for asking the right questions during stakeholder discovery.

2.1.1 Learning objectives

By the end of this chapter, a team member should be able to:

- explain the broad evolution and public-service role of Karnataka Police;
- distinguish state-level leadership, territorial command and specialised functional units;
- describe the difference between a district police arrangement and a commissionerate arrangement;
- identify the role of a police station as a local operational and public-facing unit;
- explain why rank, designation, posting, jurisdiction and application permission must be modelled separately;
- identify which organisational facts need confirmation from current government orders before implementation.

2.2 History and Evolution of Karnataka Police

2.2.1 Historical foundations

The official Karnataka State Police website describes the modern force as having evolved from the princely-state forces of Mysuru and other regional forces that formed the foundation of the present organisation. This is an important starting point: the history of policing in the territory now known as Karnataka includes different local arrangements and institutional traditions, rather than one single uniform organisation existing unchanged through time. [1]

2.2.2 Evolution into a modern state police organisation

Over time, local and regional arrangements developed into a professional state police institution with responsibilities that include public safety, enforcement of traffic laws, crime investigation and emergency assistance. The modern department also works in partnership with communities and other parts of the criminal justice system. The Karnataka Police Act, 1963 (Karnataka Act 4 of 1964), provides an important part of the state-specific statutory framework for the constitution, superintendence and administration of the police force. [2]

2.2.3 Professionalisation and specialisation

Modern policing requires more than general-duty police stations. It depends on specialised knowledge and support capabilities such as investigation, intelligence, communications, training, reserve forces, cybercrime response, traffic management and forensic science. A historical Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) review of Karnataka's police modernisation programme documented a range of functional branches and support capabilities at that time. Its organogram is useful as a historical reference, but it must not be treated as a current posting chart. [3]

2.2.4 What the project should take from this history

The project should respect institutional experience and existing processes while examining where better coordination, records, training, equipment management and digital support could help. It should not assume that a new application should replace established professional practices. Any redesign should be tested with the personnel who perform the work and approved by the department.

Historical research task: before publishing a later, more detailed historical timeline, the team should locate and verify official police histories, Karnataka Gazette records, government notifications and archival material. Do not add dates, founding claims or names of former officials from unsourced summaries.

2.3 The Department's Mandate and Public-Service Role

Police functions are broad and vary with the legal authority, assignment and unit involved. For project discovery, the team's first-level map should include the following responsibility groups:

Responsibility group	Typical subject matter to understand
Public safety and order	Public order duties, prevention and response to disturbances, event-related arrangements and protection of people.
Crime reporting and investigation	Receipt of information, lawful registration and recording, investigation, case documentation, evidence handling and supervisory review.
Emergency assistance	Receiving or coordinating urgent requests, allocating resources through authorised channels and recording response activity.
Traffic and road safety	Traffic regulation, collision response, enforcement, congestion management and road-safety initiatives.
Community and citizen services	Public enquiries, approved verification services, assistance to vulnerable persons, awareness and community engagement.
Specialist policing	Work requiring specialist teams, technical skills, dedicated procedures or coordination across units.
Department administration	Personnel, postings, training, welfare, assets, equipment, facilities, procurement and internal reporting.

These groups are a discovery framework, not a complete legal statement of police powers. Each operational capability must later be mapped to its applicable statute, rules, government order, departmental manual and authorised officer.

2.4 Understanding the Three Dimensions of Police Organisation

A useful way to understand the department is to separate three structures that overlap in day-to-day work.

2.4.1 Command and supervisory structure

The command structure explains authority, reporting and supervision. A senior officer may supervise a range, district, commissionerate, state-level function or specialised organisation. The correct reporting line depends on the post and the current administrative arrangement. The project must obtain the approved organogram rather than infer reporting relationships from rank alone.

2.4.2 Territorial and jurisdictional structure

The territorial structure divides responsibility across geographical areas. Depending on the area and the applicable administrative arrangement, a matter may fall within a commissionerate, district, subdivision, circle, police station or another notified unit. Jurisdiction determines which unit is responsible for local policing functions and which supervisory path applies.

2.4.3 Functional and specialist structure

The functional structure groups personnel and resources around a particular subject, such as investigation, intelligence, traffic, training, reserve forces, communications or cybercrime. A functional unit may operate across several districts or support multiple territorial commands.

THREE CONNECTED VIEWS OF THE DEPARTMENT

COMMAND	TERRITORY	FUNCTION
Who supervises?	Where is responsibility?	What specialist work is done?
Senior officers and reporting lines	Ranges, districts, commissionerates, stations	CID, traffic, intelligence, cybercrime, training, etc.

The same officer can have a rank, hold a particular post, belong to a unit and be assigned a jurisdiction at the same time.

2.4.4 Why the distinction matters

Suppose an officer of a particular rank is temporarily placed in charge of a unit, while retaining a substantive rank and being assigned to a defined jurisdiction. The software needs to represent the officer's identity, rank, current post, unit, effective dates, supervisory line and permissions independently. A single field called `role` or `designation` cannot safely represent all of these facts.

2.5 State-Level Leadership and Headquarters

2.5.1 Director General and Inspector General of Police

The public-facing Karnataka State Police website identifies the Director General and Inspector General of Police (DG&IGP) as the head of the state police force. The office provides overall leadership and is the senior state-level reference point for the department. [1]

2.5.2 Senior leadership and functional portfolios

Senior officers may be assigned state-level portfolios covering broad functions such as law and order, crime, administration, intelligence, recruitment and training, technical services or other specialised responsibilities. The actual portfolio names, officer assignments and reporting lines can change. For that reason, the project should store these as effective-dated organisational data rather than hard-code them in application logic.

2.5.3 State Police Headquarters

The State Police Headquarters in Bengaluru provides a central administrative and leadership location for the department. At a conceptual level, headquarters-level activities may include strategic direction, policy coordination, statewide administration, planning, oversight, resource allocation and coordination among functional and territorial units. Exact responsibilities must be confirmed against the current departmental allocation of work and official orders.

2.5.4 Headquarters as a system-level user group

The project may eventually provide authorised headquarters users with statewide reports, policy and circular repositories, organisational directories, approved workflow monitoring and administrative dashboards. Statewide visibility must not automatically mean unrestricted access to case files, intelligence, personal data or evidence. Access should follow purpose, jurisdiction, rank-independent authorisation and audit requirements.

2.6 Police Ranges, Districts and Sub-District Organisation

2.6.1 Police ranges

A range is a supervisory grouping used to coordinate policing across multiple districts. A range-level office can provide supervision, review, coordination and escalation across its constituent district units. The precise number, names, boundaries and current officer assignments of ranges must be obtained from the latest authorised Karnataka Police organogram and government notifications.

2.6.2 District police organisation

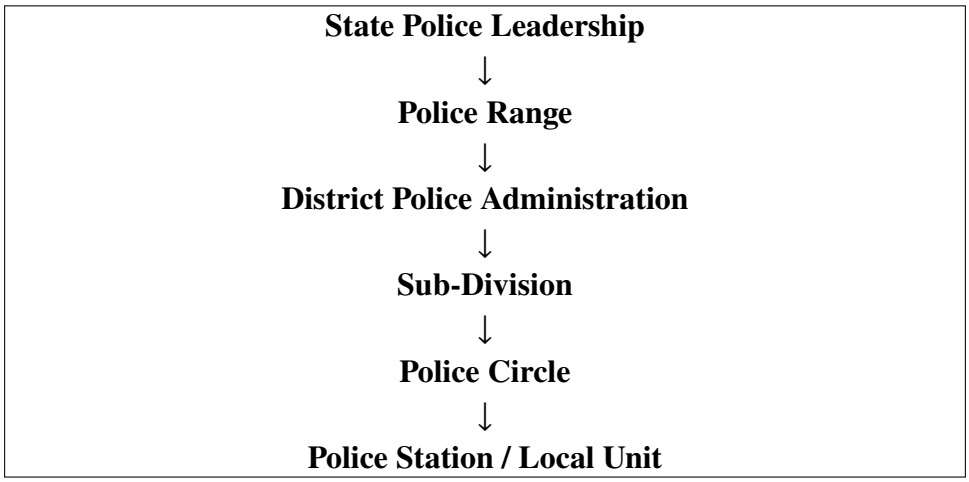
In a district-police arrangement, the Superintendent of Police (SP) is generally the district-level unit officer. The district structure may include additional or assistant superintendents, sub-divisional officers, circle-level officers and police stations. A Government of Karnataka district information page describes this general pattern and explains that stations are the basic local units through which public-facing policing is delivered. [4]

2.6.3 Sub-divisions and circles

Districts may be organised into sub-divisions and circles to support supervision across groups of police stations. The exact number and boundaries are administrative facts that can change and must be verified. The project should not assume every district has an identical number of sub-divisions, circles or stations.

2.6.4 Territorial hierarchy as a conceptual model

The following is a simplified model for understanding the district-police path. It is not a universal chart for every unit and does not override commissionerate arrangements or special notifications.



2.6.5 A source discrepancy that must be resolved

The public material reviewed for this chapter is not fully aligned on the exact number of ranges. A Government of Karnataka district information page describes six Inspectors General in charge of ranges, while a separate public-facing Karnataka Police organisation listing describes seven ranges. [4, 5] The project must not choose one count by assumption. Before any master data is created, the team must obtain the current approved organogram, the latest range and district notifications, and written confirmation from the departmental owner.

Design rule: ranges, districts, circles, police stations and their boundaries must be maintained as configurable, effective-dated master data. The application must not rely on hard-coded district lists, fixed parent-child relationships or names embedded in source code.

2.7 Police Commissionerates

2.7.1 Meaning of a commissionerate

A police commissionerate is a notified policing arrangement for a specified urban area. It is headed by a Commissioner of Police, supported by officers such as Additional or Joint Commissioners, Deputy Commissioners and Assistant Commissioners where those posts exist. The exact structure depends on government notifications and local arrangements.

2.7.2 Statutory basis

Section 7 of the Karnataka Police Act, 1963 provides for the appointment of a Commissioner of Police for Bengaluru or another area specified by a government notification. Section 11 provides for deputies and assistants to the Commissioner. The Act also addresses the relationship between a notified commissionerate area and other territorial authorities for the powers covered by the Act. The precise legal effect must be read with the current amended text and the relevant notifications. [2]

2.7.3 Publicly listed urban commissionerates

A public-facing Karnataka Police organisation listing reviewed for this chapter names Bengaluru City, Mysuru City, Hubballi-Dharwad City, Mangaluru City, Belagavi City and Kalaburagi City as commissionerates. [5] This is useful as a discovery lead, not as a substitute for the latest notifications establishing the area, effective date, powers, boundaries and organisational structure of each commissionerate.

2.7.4 How a commissionerate differs from a district arrangement

Both arrangements perform local policing responsibilities, but their command structures and statutory powers can differ. A commissionerate may have Commissioners, Deputy Commissioners of Police (DCPs) and Assistant Commissioners of Police (ACPs), while a district arrangement may use SPs, Additional SPs, Deputy SPs and circle officers. The exact allocation of powers is defined by law and notification, not by the software's labels.

2.7.5 System implications

A platform must support both arrangements without forcing them into one fixed hierarchy. A police station should be attached to the correct operational unit and notified jurisdiction. A DCP/ACP hierarchy should not be represented as a mere renaming of SP/DySP fields unless the relevant government data model confirms that relationship.

2.8 Police Stations and Local Operational Units

2.8.1 Police station as the public-facing unit

A police station is a major local point of contact between the public and the police. Its work can involve receiving information, recording complaints and other prescribed records, responding to local incidents, carrying out investigations assigned to it, maintaining station records, conducting beat and patrol activities and coordinating with supervisory and specialist units. The precise procedures are governed by law, rules, manuals and departmental instructions.

2.8.2 Station leadership and personnel

A station is headed by the officer designated under the applicable arrangement. Depending on the station type and local structure, the station may be led by an Inspector or a Sub-Inspector and supported by other ranks. The project must not assume that every station has the same staff strength, internal desks, specialist capabilities or supervisory arrangement.

2.8.3 Common station-level work areas

For requirements discovery, the team should examine the following work areas separately:

- public reception, enquiry and assistance;
- complaint intake and routing;
- statutory recording and registration processes;
- investigation assignment and case documentation;
- station diary, general records and prescribed registers;
- beat, patrol and local area coordination;
- summons, warrants and court-related coordination;
- evidence receipt, storage, movement and handover;
- custody-related records and safeguards, where applicable;
- reporting to supervisory officers and specialist units.

2.8.4 Police stations are not interchangeable

A large urban station, a rural station, a women police station, a traffic station, a coastal station, a railway police unit or a cybercrime-focused unit may have different responsibilities, staffing, workflows and jurisdictional arrangements. The master data model must accommodate station type and functional classification without assuming that every station performs every type of work.

2.9 Police Ranks, Posts and Designations

2.9.1 Rank and designation

A **rank** describes a person's place in the police rank structure. A **post or designation** describes the office or assignment the person currently holds. A **unit** identifies the organisational body to which the person is assigned. These concepts may be related but are not identical. One rank may be associated with several kinds of posting, and the title used in a commissionerate may differ from the title used in a district unit.

2.9.2 Commonly encountered ranks and levels

The following table is an orientation aid. It is not a complete service-rule statement, a promotion ladder, a pay matrix or a guarantee that every unit uses every level in the same way.

Rank / level commonly used	General orientation for the project team
Director General of Police (DGP)	Senior police rank used for top state-level and specialised leadership appointments.
Additional Director General of Police (ADGP)	Senior leadership rank commonly associated with major state-level portfolios or large units.
Inspector General of Police (IGP)	Senior supervisory rank that may be associated with range or functional leadership.
Deputy Inspector General of Police (DIG)	Senior supervisory rank that may be associated with a range, commissionerate or specialised assignment.
Superintendent of Police (SP)	District-level leadership designation in a district-police arrangement; also used in other contexts.
Additional / Assistant Superintendent of Police	Senior district or sub-divisional responsibilities, according to posting and cadre.
Deputy Superintendent of Police (DySP)	Commonly associated with sub-divisional or other supervisory duties.
Police Inspector (PI)	May head a station, circle or specialist function depending on the posting.
Police Sub-Inspector (PSI)	Commonly performs investigation, station and supervisory duties according to assignment.
Assistant Sub-Inspector (ASI)	Supports station, investigation and supervisory functions as assigned.
Head Constable (HC)	Experienced subordinate-rank personnel with operational and station responsibilities.
Police Constable (PC)	Frontline personnel performing field, station, security and other assigned duties.

2.9.3 Commissionerate designations

Commissionerate structures may use designations such as Commissioner of Police (CP), Additional Commissioner, Joint Commissioner, Deputy Commissioner of Police (DCP) and Assistant Commissioner of Police (ACP). A designation does not by itself establish the complete statutory power of the office; the governing law, notification and current allocation of work must be checked.

2.9.4 Rank is not an application permission

The project must avoid a simplistic rule such as "all officers above rank X can access all records". Permissions should reflect lawful purpose, current assignment, jurisdiction, case responsibility, supervisory need and data sensitivity. Some permissions may require a separate approval or temporary delegation. All privileged access should be logged and periodically reviewed.

2.10 Specialised and Functional Units

Specialised units allow the department to develop and deploy expertise for particular types of work. The list below is a project discovery map. It is not a definitive current organogram, and the current names, reporting lines, mandates and territorial reach of each unit must be confirmed.

2.10.1 Criminal Investigation Department

The Criminal Investigation Department (CID) is associated with specialised investigation and crime-related functions. The project should understand which matters are handled by CID, how cases are referred or transferred, what investigative records are maintained and how CID coordinates with district or commissionerate units. Access to CID case material must be governed by the relevant authorisation and sensitivity rules.

2.10.2 Central Crime Branch and city crime units

Central Crime Branch (CCB) is a term used for specialised crime investigation units in certain city-police contexts. Its exact name, scope and reporting line should be confirmed separately for the relevant commissionerate. The software must not assume that every commissionerate has an identical CCB structure or that CCB is a statewide territorial authority.

2.10.3 State Intelligence and Internal Security

Intelligence and internal-security functions deal with sensitive information and specialist assessments. A modernisation platform should not merge this material into general-purpose operational dashboards. Any proposed support system requires strict purpose limitation, compartmentalised access, explicit approvals, auditability and a separate legal and security

assessment.

2.10.4 Karnataka State Reserve Police

The Karnataka State Reserve Police (KSRP) is a reserve capability that may support law-and-order deployment, security duties and major operations. The project should study mobilisation requests, deployment orders, personnel availability, transport, equipment, training and return-to-unit processes. Operational details and deployment information must be protected.

2.10.5 Traffic Police

Traffic policing may be organised through city traffic divisions and district-level traffic units. Its responsibilities can include traffic regulation, enforcement, road safety, collision response and congestion management. The team should map the traffic jurisdiction, existing challan and vehicle systems, field devices, court interfaces and approved data exchanges before proposing a new platform.

2.10.6 Cybercrime and CEN police capabilities

Cybercrime work requires specialised intake, technical investigation, digital evidence handling, financial-fraud coordination, legal process and training. Karnataka has an established Centre for Cyber Crime Investigation Training and Research (CCITR), described by the Data Security Council of India as a capacity-building collaboration involving CID Karnataka, DSCI and Infosys Foundation. This is an example of an existing capability that the programme should understand and complement, rather than duplicate without assessment. [6]

2.10.7 Women and child safety functions

Women and child safety work may involve dedicated help desks, women police stations, specialised investigators, child protection coordination and victim-support services. The project must understand confidentiality, sensitive record access, child-friendly procedures, referral pathways and applicable legal requirements. These workflows should not be treated as ordinary complaint forms with only a different category label.

2.10.8 Communications, technical support and modernisation

Communication and technical functions support operational connectivity, wireless communications, devices, systems and related infrastructure. Historical CAG material identifies communication and technical branches in the department's earlier organisational structure. Current names, responsibilities and equipment ownership should be confirmed with the relevant technical authority. [3]

2.10.9 Recruitment, training and police academies

Recruitment and training institutions support entry-level training, in-service training, specialist capability development and professional standards. The project should identify current training institutions, their course structures, training calendars, attendance records, learning resources, assessment methods and certification authorities.

2.10.10 Forensic science and fingerprint capabilities

Forensic science laboratories and fingerprint services provide scientific examination and expert support. Their administrative relationship to the police department must be established from current government orders; they should not automatically be modelled as ordinary police stations or police units. The software may need controlled workflows for laboratory requests, exhibit tracking, reports and expert communications, with evidentiary safeguards.

2.10.11 Other specialist functions

Other specialist or support functions may include railway policing, coastal policing, civil-rights enforcement, special task forces, motor transport, wireless communications and police computer or IT support. The team must build an authoritative unit inventory from the latest departmental directory and notifications before deciding which capabilities require dedicated software modules.

2.11 A Practical View of Police Work Across Units

The same incident may involve more than one unit. A local police station may receive the initial information; a control room may coordinate urgent assistance; a specialist investigation unit may provide technical support; a forensic laboratory may examine exhibits; and a prosecutor or court may later receive records through authorised processes. This does not mean all participants should see the same information or that every step can be automated.

2.11.1 Example: a reported digital financial fraud

The following is a simplified illustration of possible coordination, not an official standard operating procedure:

1. A citizen contacts an authorised reporting channel or police unit.
2. The information is recorded and routed according to the applicable procedure and jurisdiction.
3. An authorised officer assesses the information and determines the appropriate investigative and escalation steps.
4. Where applicable, the matter is coordinated with relevant cybercrime capabilities and financial institutions through lawful channels.

5. Digital evidence and documents are handled using approved preservation, seizure, transfer and chain-of-custody procedures.
6. Supervisors review progress according to their authority; prosecution and court processes follow applicable law.

The software's potential role is to support accurate records, task handovers, secure document handling and visibility of authorised workflow status. It must not independently decide whether an offence has occurred, freeze an account, determine guilt or replace the judgement of authorised officers and institutions.

2.12 Existing Public-Facing Digital Touchpoints

The official Karnataka State Police website provides links to several public-facing services and institutional resources. The English portal includes links to recruitment, FIR search, Seva Sindhu, a citizen-centric portal, KSP e-Lost Reports and a police-station locator. It also links to external justice and policing resources such as ICJS, NCRB, MHA, BPR&D and the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal. [1]

2.12.1 What the existence of a portal tells us

A public link establishes that a service or resource is being presented to citizens or visitors through the official website. It does not establish that the project team has an API, that the service is available in every district, that data may be replicated, or that a system owner has approved integration. Those questions require technical documentation and formal permission.

2.12.2 Digital discovery checklist

For each existing portal or platform, the discovery team should record:

- the official owner and operational contact;
- the service purpose and user population;
- the legal and administrative authority for the service;
- the authoritative source of each data element;
- whether an API or other approved interface exists;
- authentication, authorisation and audit requirements;
- data-sharing terms, retention rules and permitted uses;
- service hours, availability, support and escalation arrangements;
- known limitations, duplicate workflows and user feedback.

2.13 Implications for the Modernisation Project

Understanding the organisation directly affects system design. A department-wide platform must support changes in postings, jurisdiction boundaries, supervisory structures and specialised responsibilities without requiring software code changes for every administrative update.

2.13.1 Required master-data concepts

The initial conceptual data model should distinguish at least the following entities:

- **Person:** an individual employee or authorised external user;
- **Rank:** the formally recognised rank or service classification;
- **Designation:** the title associated with a post or assignment;
- **Post:** an authorised position within the approved establishment;
- **Organisational unit:** headquarters, range, district, commissionerate, division, circle, station or specialist unit;
- **Jurisdiction:** the approved geographical or functional area of responsibility;
- **Posting:** the time-bounded assignment of a person to a post or unit;
- **Reporting relationship:** the current supervisory or administrative relationship;
- **Application role:** a bundle of technical permissions for a specific system;
- **Delegation:** a controlled, time-limited grant of authority where formally permitted.

2.13.2 Effective dates and organisational history

Organisational relationships change. Every posting, unit boundary, reporting line and delegation that influences access or workflow should have an effective start date and, where applicable, an end date. The system should preserve historical records so that an audit can determine which officer and unit were responsible at the time an action occurred.

2.13.3 Jurisdiction-aware workflows

A complaint, incident or case may be associated with a location, a police station, a commissionerate or district, and one or more specialist units. The system should preserve the difference between the place where an event occurred, the unit that first received the information, the unit that currently owns the workflow and the unit providing specialist support.

2.13.4 Configurable organisation directory

A central organisation directory should be managed by an authorised departmental data owner. It should support official unit codes, names in Kannada and English, parent-child relationships, unit types, active status, jurisdiction links, contact information and effective dates. Changes should be versioned and approved; ordinary application users should not be able to create or alter official units at will.

2.13.5 Access-control design

The access-control model should combine role-based permissions with contextual checks where necessary. For example, a user may hold a general investigator permission but should access a particular case only where the user's assignment, jurisdiction, supervisory authority or another approved legal basis allows it. Sensitive units may need additional compartmentalisation and more frequent access review.

2.14 Stakeholder Discovery and Verification Questions

Before freezing the department model, the team should seek answers to the following questions from authorised departmental stakeholders:

1. What is the current approved state-level organogram, including all functional portfolios?
2. What are the officially notified police ranges, their headquarters and current district mappings?
3. What are the current commissionerates, their notified areas and the latest organisational charts?
4. Which districts or urban areas operate under district-police arrangements, commissionerate arrangements or special arrangements?
5. What are the official codes and names for ranges, districts, subdivisions, circles and police stations?
6. Which specialist units exist today, and what are their mandates, reporting lines and jurisdictions?
7. Which functions are delivered by police units and which by separate departments or agencies?
8. What is the authoritative source for officer identity, rank, posting, duty assignment and transfer information?
9. Which roles may approve, reassign, review or close each major workflow?
10. Which existing systems are authoritative for complaints, FIRs, crime records, personnel, traffic, forensics and court-related information?

11. Which data can be shared, for what purpose, under which authority and through which approved interface?
12. What administrative changes must the software support without a new software release?

2.15 Chapter Summary

Karnataka Police is a professional state institution whose modern identity developed from the police forces and traditions of the former Mysuru princely state and other regional areas. Its organisation must be understood through separate but connected command, territorial and functional structures. State headquarters provides statewide leadership and coordination; ranges and districts provide territorial supervision; commissionerates operate under a separately notified urban policing arrangement; police stations deliver important local and public-facing functions; and specialist units contribute capabilities that may cross territorial boundaries.

For the modernisation project, the most important design lesson is to avoid representing the entire department as one static hierarchy. Rank, designation, post, organisational unit, jurisdiction, posting, reporting line and system permission must be represented separately, with effective dates and approval controls. Current unit names, boundaries and reporting relationships must be verified from the latest authorised departmental records before implementation.

END OF CHAPTER 2

References and Source Notes

The following public sources were used to prepare the chapter. Web pages and organisational descriptions can change; the access date for current web material is 11 November 2026. Where public descriptions conflict or appear incomplete, the chapter flags the issue instead of treating an unverified detail as settled fact.

[1] Karnataka State Police, official English portal. Open source

[2] Government of India, India Code, The Karnataka Police Act, 1963 (Karnataka Act 4 of 1964). Open source

[3] Comptroller and Auditor General of India, Report No. 2 of 2018, General and Social Sector, Government of Karnataka; performance audit section on modernisation of police force. This is a historical audit and organisational reference, not a current organogram. Open source

[4] Kolar District Administration, Government of Karnataka, Police Department overview. The page provides a general description of district and range arrangements; current details must be checked against notifications. Open source

[5] Karnataka State Police public-facing organisation listing. Used only as a secondary public description to identify a possible discrepancy in range count and to prepare questions for official verification. Open source

[6] Data Security Council of India, Centre for Cybercrime Investigation Training and Research (CCITR). Open source

Verification note

This chapter intentionally avoids treating every public web description as authoritative. Before the organisational master data is approved, the department should provide the latest signed organogram, government notifications establishing ranges and commissionerates, official station and unit directories, and the relevant allocation-of-business orders. If those documents differ from public website descriptions, the signed and current government records should take precedence.